

BENZYL SALICYLATE

_____ Name
_____ Date

also called... **salicylic acid benzyl ester, 2-hydroxybenzoic acid phenylmethyl ester, and benzyl o-hydroxybenzoate.**

What is it?

Benzyl salicylate is a widely used solvent with a slight pleasant odor. It is formed by combining benzyl alcohol with salicylic acid.

Where might it be found?

cologne
perfume
body spray
aftershave
moisturizing cream
lotion
facial moisturizer
anti-aging cream
night serum, oil
hand cream
lipstick, lip gloss
sunscreen
sunless tanning cream
shampoo
hair conditioner
hair styling gel
hair color
hair bleaching agent
laundry detergent
stain remover
fabric softener
dryer sheets
prescription psoralens

How to avoid it:

Avoid using any product that contains **benzyl salicylate** or one of its other names listed above. In some products it may be added as an unspecified “fragrance” or “parfum.” Therefore it is best to *avoid all fragranced products.*

Be sure to check the complete ingredient list on the label of each product you use. If you cannot find the ingredient list, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products’ ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer’s website, the store’s website, or at websites like <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>.

For possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list for all products encountered.

Be sure to tell your doctor, nurse, attendant, hairdresser, masseuse, aesthetician, and others involved in your personal care about this sensitivity.

By reading ingredient labels, you should be able to avoid this allergen and find safe alternatives that are free of it.